



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant School

School Website: <https://covenantschoolwv.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit Report: Berean Christian Academy (Katy, TX)

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly centers its mission on a Christ-centered worldview and the transcendentals of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; it implements the Trivium (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric), Great Books, Latin, logic, debate/Harkness discussion, and a Senior Thesis capstone; lower grades emphasize memorization via songs and chants; the website outlines theological integration (Bible every year, catechism, hymn studies, scripture memory) and a "Portrait of a Teacher/Graduate/Parent" that stresses wisdom, virtue, and partnership with families. Evidence throughout the site maps tightly to the Six Essential Elements keyword framework. - Website used: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org/>

Method and Scoring Framework - Framework: The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword indicators (positive and negative) were used as the scoring backbone for each category, supported by the classicality keyword lexicon across all six elements. Quantification below reflects presence/absence of these terms in the school's public materials.

School Snapshot (from crawl data) - Address and basics: "600 Pin Oak Rd, Katy, TX 77494; bereanchristianacademy.org; 346-307-7491... independent, interdenominational, classical Christian school... founded in 2016... ACCS and SCL member." - **Mission:** "educate students in a Christ-centered worldview, equipped to recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty... partnership between faculty and parents." - **Trivium and curriculum highlights:** Trivium stages by grade band; Latin III–VI, formal Logic and Rhetoric, Harkness table conversations, Great Books/original texts, theology/philosophy, Rhetoric capstone (Senior Thesis). Chronological History cycles; integration across subjects; Bible yearly; hymn studies, catechism, scripture memory. - **Lower school pedagogy:** "Garden years" of wonder; repetition, songs, chants, memorization; delight in beautiful literature, poetry, classical music, and art. - **House system hint:** Merchandise labeled "Mozart House Shirt," indicating houses.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: truth, goodness, beauty; Christ-centered worldview; theology; apologetics; catechism; hymn studies; scripture memory; Deuteronomy 6 emphasis; formation "grounded in the Word of God." 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Transcendental moral realism: explicit "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty." - Grounded in theology: theology, apologetics, biblical worldview across subjects. - Liturgical/-communal: hymn studies, catechism, scripture memory daily. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 10 (truth, goodness, beauty, Christ-centered worldview, theology, apologetics, catechism, hymn studies, scripture memory, biblical worldview) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage of sub-criteria: 100% 4) Justification - The site directly affirms transcendentals, theological integration, and daily practices (hymn/catechism/scripture memory) that reflect liturgical formation, closely matching the positive keyword lists.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: formation in wisdom and virtue; pursuit/recognition of truth, goodness, beauty; portrait of graduate explicitly features virtue, love of truth/goodness/beauty; “not only to make a living, but to live.” 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Ends of education: wisdom and virtue over mere career-readiness; transcendental aims. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 8 (wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, love of beauty, formation, human flourishing theme) - Negative hits: 0 (no “college/career readiness” marketing emphasis) - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100% 4) Justification - Purpose and goal language strongly aligns to the element’s positive indicators; no utilitarian emphasis is foregrounded.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; original ancient texts; Latin III–VI; Rhetoric I/II and Senior Thesis; Debate/Harkness; History (not “social studies”) with chronological cycles; integration of subjects; wonder (Garden years). 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Liberal Arts (trivium/quadrivium signals), Great Books/primary sources, robust History, integration and wonder. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 14 (Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Great Books, primary texts, debate, Harkness, Senior Thesis, chronological history, integration, wonder, theology/philosophy) - Negative hits: 0 (no “social studies”-in-lieu-of-history or “project-based learning” emphasis) - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100% 4) Justification - Curriculum language matches all core positives for classical curriculum content and structure.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY/TEACHING METHODS — CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: songs, chants, memorization in lower school; cultivating wonder; formal logic, debate, Harkness (Socratic/dialectic); Rhetoric instruction; Senior Thesis/oral defense to a panel. 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Memorization/recitation, dialectic/Socratic, rhetoric/senior thesis, wonder—all featured. “Scholé/restful” language is not explicit. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 9 (singing/chanting/memorization, wonder, logic, debate, Harkness, Socratic style, rhetoric, oratory, thesis defense) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 75% (all but explicit “scholé/restful” wording) 4) Justification - Pedagogical methods correspond closely to classical patterns in both lower and upper grades. Minor gap: explicit mention of scholé.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY — CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: “Portrait of a Teacher” describing teachers who model virtue, are disciples of Jesus, lifelong learners, uphold high standards, and mentor students in wisdom and right thinking; “available and approachable.” 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Teachers as models of virtue; mentorship and collegiality. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 6 (model virtue, disciple of Christ, integrity, lifelong learner, wisdom/formation, mentorship posture) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 85% (robust portrait; collegial language implied though not deeply elaborated) 4) Justification - Faculty are framed as the “living curriculum” modeling virtue and wisdom, in line with the element’s positives.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL 1) Keywords found on site (examples) - Positive indicators: partnership between faculty and parents (mission); “Portrait of a Parent” underscores faithful partnership in Christian education. - Additional signals: likely house system (“Mozart House Shirt”). 2) Mapping to Six Elements - Clear parental partnership; however, explicit “parent formation” activities (book groups, seminars) and “open campus” language not seen in crawl excerpts. 3) Quantification - Positive hits: 4 (parent partnership, co-laboring ethos, portrait of a parent, community identity via houses) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 65% (parent formation and “parents welcome anytime” not explicitly stated) 4) Justification - Strong partnership language, but thinner evidence for ongoing parent formation offerings; thus “Somewhat Classical” for this category given partial coverage.

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Five categories score Classical with strong keyword matches and comprehensive coverage; Parents & Community scores Somewhat Classical due to limited evidence of parent formation programming/open-campus statements in the crawl samples. Overall, the school clearly embodies the classical Christian model in mission, aims, curriculum, pedagogy, and faculty formation.

Detailed Evidence Highlights (select) - Mission centering TGB and parent partnership: - Trivium, Great Books, primary texts, Latin through VI, Rhetoric + Senior Thesis: - Theology/Apologetics/World Religions coursework: - Lower-school chanting/songs/memorization; wonder in “Garden years”: - Daily hymn studies, catechism, scripture memory: - Socratic/Harkness conversations and debate: - Portraits of Teacher/Gradu-

ate/Parent emphasize virtue, wisdom, beauty, partnership:

Overall Classicality Metrics (by category) - 1 Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: rating CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 100 | pos_neg_hits +10/-0 - 2 Purpose & Goal: rating CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 100 | pos_neg_hits +8/-0 - 3 Curriculum: rating CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 100 | pos_neg_hits +14/-0 - 4 Pedagogy: rating CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 75 | pos_neg_hits +9/-0 - 5 Faculty: rating CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 85 | pos_neg_hits +6/-0 - 6 Parents & Community: rating SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL | percent_positive 100 | percent_coverage 65 | pos_neg_hits +4/-0

What would move the needle (Element 6: Parents & Community) - Offer and publicize explicit “parent formation” (e.g., book studies on classical education, seminars, classical parent reading groups) on the website’s parent/community pages. - Make “open campus” language or parent visitation posture explicit (e.g., “parents welcome to visit,” hospitality events following the liturgical calendar). - Provide a dedicated page outlining ongoing partnership practices (parent covenant; how the school equips parents as co-educators).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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